

**LISTENING
#27****Teacher's Guide****SCRIPT: ASSIGNING ROLES**

Shaun: Orla. On your way to the project meeting?

Orla: Yes.

Shaun: It's the first time this team has worked together, isn't it? No pressure.

Orla: Well, we're really just working out team roles today. The client pitch is not for another six weeks. The question is: do I just tell them what I'd like them to do, or let them figure it out themselves? Part of me wants to let them decide. Part of me just wants to tell them.

Shaun: Well, there are some strong personalities in that team, so I wouldn't give them too much freedom. I'd just tell them if I were you.

Orla: I'll let you know how it goes.

Orla: That's the project covered. Now, team roles. Alex, I'd like you to be pitch leader. You've got the most project management experience.

Orla: Now Azra, I thought lead presenter for you this time. We've talked about you wanting to develop your presentation skills.

Orla: Jasmine, I'm going to ask you to be the learning designer.

Jasmine: Oh, um...

Orla: Problem?

Jasmine: Well, no. It's just quite a lot of responsibility.

Orla: You're a learning and development specialist, and you're a responsible person. You'll be fine.

Orla: Finally, Thiago. Tech support. You're so good with technology.

Azra: Actually, Orla, I'm really not comfortable presenting, especially in front of a new client.

Alex: I agree. Azra should be the pitch leader on this one, and I can take care of the presentation. And maybe Thiago could help me out. He needs something bigger than tech support.

Thiago: Yeah, why do I always get tech support?

Azra: And, well, maybe Jasmine also feels like I do about her role.

Jasmine: I am worried. It's a big responsibility.

Alex: Perhaps Thiago can help me present and do the slides?

Thiago: Wait a minute. I'm doing the presentation and the slides?

Orla: Everyone, please! Your first time together as a team, and you're arguing about everything. Let's just think about this.

Audio Comprehension Questions:

1. a) It's the first time the team is meeting
2. b) Whether to assign roles herself or let the team decide
3. To be more direct and tell them what to do
4. b) Pitch leader
5. She wants to help Azra develop her presentation skills
6. She feels it's a lot of responsibility
7. He always gets the same kind of task
8. They argue and try to change their roles
9. She tells them to stop arguing and think about it calmly

Reading Comprehension Questions

1. People don't know each other's strengths yet
2. The meeting can become confusing
3. Playing to their strengths

Idioms

“Let them figure it out” = allow others to solve or decide something on their own

“Play to their strengths” = use one's best abilities to achieve success

“Pitch leader” = the person responsible for leading and organizing a presentation to a client or audience